

Yixiong Hao

yixiong_hao@outlook.com | (470)-457-3887 | [Website](#) | [LinkedIn](#) | [GitHub](#) | [Google Scholar](#)

EDUCATION

Georgia Institute of Technology

Atlanta, Georgia

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science & BSMS. GPA: 4.0

Jan 2024 – May 2027

- **Coursework:** DSA II, OOP, Objects & Design, Systems & Networks, Linear Algebra, Calculus III, AI, Deep Learning.

EXPERIENCE

Grantmaker (Astra Fellowship) | [Astralis Foundation](#)

Aug 2026 – Jan 2027

- Grantmaker #3, focusing on AI strategy and opportunities in Asia to reduce societal scale risks from AI.

MLE Intern | [Gray Swan AI](#)

May 2026 – Aug 2026

- Self directed research on LLM robustness to Indirect Prompt Injections + strategy and collaborations work to accelerate 3rd party evaluations.

Co-founder and Research Manager | [Second Look Research](#)

March 2026 – Present

- Raised \$600k+ USD to replicate and open source decision relevant empirical research in AI safety.
- Co-owned organizational strategy, hiring pipeline, program design, and research management.

Co-director, Advisor | [Georgia Tech AI Safety Initiative](#)

2024 – Present

- Grew organizer headcount from 2 to 16, fellowship participants from 30 to 70+ per cohort, reached 1k+ students through events, members published 15+ papers at peer reviewed venues.
- Placed 15+ members in full time equivalent roles at key organizations including METR, MATS, Anthropic, IAPS, Constellation.

Researcher | [UChicago XLab](#), [PAIR Lab @ GT](#)

May 2024 – 2026

- Proof of existence for a novel threat model involving **agentic misalignment in RLVR style post training** in collaboration with the Center for AI Safety.
- Leading early mechanistic interpretability work on low level actuators policies like Vision-Language-Action models.

Quantitative Finance Research Intern | [China Industrial Securities](#)

Jun 2024 – Aug 2024

- Trained the **deep momentum** strategy in the Chinese stock market, achieving a **1.80 Sharpe ratio** with a long-short portfolio in back-testing. Used TensorFlow to build a deep neural network that classified stocks into expected return deciles based on momentum factors and implemented downstream statistical processing.
- **Optimized the proposed model to ~20% the original size** with grid search and no significant loss of performance.

SELECT PUBLICATIONS

[Patterns and Mechanisms of Contrastive Activation Engineering](#)

ICLR 2025 Workshop

Y. Hao, A. Panda, S. Shabalin, S. A. R. Ali

[Interpreting Large Text-to-Image Diffusion Models with Dictionary Learning](#)

CVPR 2025 Workshop

S. Shabalin, A. Panda, D. Kharlapenko, A. R. Ali, Y. Hao, A. Conmy

[Shall We Play a Game? Language Models for Open-ended Wargames](#)

EMNLP 2025 Workshop

G. Matlin, P. Mahajan, I. Song, Y. Hao, R. Bard, ..., M. Riedl

[Evaluation Cards: An Interpretive Layer for AI Evaluation Reporting](#)

arXiv Preprint

A. Ghosh, A. Reuel, J. Chim, ..., Y. Hao, ..., I. Solaiman

[Prioritization of Risks from Artificial Intelligence: A Delphi Study of 272 International Experts](#)

arXiv Preprint

A. K. Saeri, J. Graham, M. Noetel, ..., Y. Hao, ..., N. Thompson

PROJECTS

BuzzBot – Gatech virtual advisor

2024

- RAG system with elastic search and tool-use to answer questions about all things Gatech.

Life-sized Quadruped robot

2023

- Planned, designed, and built a fully functional robot dog with 3 DoF limbs and custom 3D printed body.
- **Stack:** ESP32, Adafruit 16 channel controller, ToF sensors, C in Arduino IDE, inverse kinematics, trajectory planning.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming Languages & tools: Python, C, Java, bash scripting, Git, Slurm, Docker, Claude Code, Django, Next.js, Agile, CI/CD.

AI & ML: PyTorch, TF, HuggingFace, NumPy, Pandas, LangChain, VeRL, reinforcement learning, evolutionary algorithms, NLP, data visualization, transformers, weights & biases.